



PHOTOS BY **MANDAR DEODHAR**

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**“We are focusing on going deeper into a city. Most of our outlets are in Delhi NCR—around 85. There are 48 in Mumbai, 20 in Pune and Kolkata. People were very sceptical about Kolkata, but we have the most successful business model there”**

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Instead, it was treated as a commodity play. Cafés back then were run as a space where people would meet. We thought there was an opportunity, and maybe over 10-20 years, things would work in our favour because building anything around coffee takes at least two-three decades.

**AB: What did starting up look like?**

**A:** We started doing our research, went to farmers. They were hesitant—asking us what we were trying to do. There was no demand in the Indian market and we wanted specialty grade beans. We were the first to start specialty coffee in India. Before us, there was no player focusing on such quality stuff. After a lot of convincing, we managed to get a couple of sacks (of